



SERENDIB COLLEGE GAMPOLA

HISTORY

2026/History/G10&11/T-2/U-4

4. The Ancient Society of Sri Lanka

1. Name the three institutions that handle the governance of a country.

2. In modern times, the parliament makes laws. What body performed this role in ancient Sri Lanka?

3. What is the primary function of the executive branch of government?

4. What is the primary function of the judiciary?

5. Why was there no independent body as a separate legislature in ancient Sri Lanka?

6. What 9th-century A.D. term used to refer to both the executive and the legislature?

7. The term 'Ekthen Samiya' is derived from 'Eka asthana' and 'Samya'. What does 'Samya' mean?

8. What is the meaning of the word 'Eka asthana' in the context of ancient ruling?

9. What does the phrase 'Wath himiyan wadala' signify in ancient inscriptions?

10. Which ancient word is used as a synonym for 'king' in various inscriptions?

11. In the 9th century A.D., what council did government officers represent when granting land to temples?

12. What role did the 'Sabhawa' play in legal acts such as bequeathing government land?

13. What was the specific duty of officers representing the 'Sabhawa' during land offerings?

14. The old Sinhala word 'Mahale' refers to which official position?

15. What was the main duty of government secretaries, or 'Mahale', in ancient times?

16. Which document provides evidence of provincial administration during King Vasabha's reign?

17. Who was the minister appointed to rule Nagadeepa during the reign of King Vasabha?

18. What term is used in inscriptions to describe the independent councils that administered groups of ten villages?

19. Where should the 'Dasagam Ettan' gather to solve problems according to the Kaludiya Pokuna inscription?

20. What is the meaning of the ancient term 'Vejjasala'?

21. What ancient term was used to identify a doctor?

22. Which king is famous for his great efforts in building hospitals between 340–368 A.D.?

23. Which king provided necessary resources to provincial hospitals between 982–1029 A.D.?

24. What was the 'Upasaggaroganasa' built by King Kashyapa IV specifically used for?

25. What was the purpose of the 'Paswantinama Sala' built by King Upatissa I?

26. What is the meaning of the word 'Thimbirige' found in ancient inscriptions?

27. In the reign of King Pandukabhaya, what were 'Sottisala' used for?

28. Which king visited the 'Chera' state in South India to attend a 'Pattini' Devala ceremony?

29. King Bhatikabhaya sent ambassadors to 'Romanuka Desha'. Which modern location does this refer to?

30. What was the purpose of King Bhatikabhaya's mission to Rome?

31. During the 8th and 9th centuries A.D., Sri Lanka developed strong foreign relations with which East Asian country?

32. During the reign of King Aggabodhi VI, how many foreign missions were sent to China?

33. What was the fundamental purpose of the marital relations between Sri Lankan and Indian royalty?

34. King Vijayabahu I married a princess from which Indian state?

35. What was the 'Veleikkara' army, and who hired them?

36. What specific duty was assigned to the Veleikkara force by King Vijayabahu I?

37. By what name did Arabian traders refer to Sri Lanka in the 9th century A.D.?

38. What were the two main types of agriculture practiced in ancient Sri Lanka?

39. Which type of agriculture is considered the oldest according to historical sources?

40. The term 'Pitibim' in inscriptions refers to which type of farming?

41. What is a 'Nawa Deli Hena'?

42. In Anuradhapura, what term is used for a Chena that is reused after being abandoned for some time?

43. Why did ancient Chena cultivation not cause significant harm to the environment?

44. Name two industrial crops grown in ancient Chenas used for making jaggery and clothes.

45. What is a 'Dandu Weta' in the context of ancient farming?

46. What is the name of the small hut built on top of a tall tree to watch over a Chena at night?

47. Name the two types of taxes charged for Chena cultivation mentioned in inscriptions.

48. Which king abolished taxes on Chena cultivation?

49. What are the terms 'Kumbura' and 'Ketha' used to describe?

50. Paddy cultivation in ancient Sri Lanka was primarily supported by which water management system?

51. What are the two main 'Kannas' or seasons for paddy cultivation?

52. Under what condition was the 'Meda Kanna' cultivated?

53. Which king famously stated, 'Not a single drop of water that falls from the sky should be sent to the sea without properly using it'?

54. What were 'Gopalagams' used for?

55. What does the term 'Kirigeri' refer to in ancient inscriptions?

56. According to the Medirigiriya hospital inscription, what kind of meat was allowed for patients?

57. What was the ancient Sinhala term for a blacksmith?

58. Name three tools commonly made by ancient blacksmiths for farmers.

59. What were goldsmiths called in ancient documents?

60. What were gem artisans called in the ancient society?

61. The term 'Datika' refers to a craftsman specialized in what material?

62. What was a 'Kumbhakara' in ancient Sri Lankan society?

63. What does the term 'Thanthu Vaya' (or Thathvaya) mean?

64. Which two cities were the most prominent 'Pura' or urban centers in ancient Sri Lanka?

65. What was 'Kalasumana'?

66. What ancient term was used for a businessman or trader?

67. What was a 'Poogaya'?

68. The Soraborawewa inscription provides detailed laws for which ancient market?

69. According to Hopitigama market laws, how was betel required to be sold?

70. What was the penalty for trading on 'Poya' days at the Hopitigama market?

71. Name one of the South Indian trade organizations active in Sri Lanka between the 11th and 13th centuries.

72. Who were the 'Cambodians' mentioned in ancient trade inscriptions?

73. What is the modern name for the ancient eastern harbour 'Gokkannathiththa'?

74. Name the northern harbour where the Sri Maha Bodhi was brought into the country.

75. Which port did Prince Dantha and Princess Hemamala use to bring the Tooth Relic to Sri Lanka?

76. What does the title 'Hasthi Acharya' signify?

77. What does the title 'Dunu Acharya' signify?

78. What was the term for a chief doctor or surgeon in the 9th century A.D.?

79. What were professionals conversant in law and justice called?

80. In ancient inscriptions, what names were given to painters?

81. When did Buddhism become the main religion of Sri Lanka?

82. What was done to natural caves to make them suitable for Buddhist monks?

83. In what language were the earliest cave inscriptions written?

84. What is a 'Pannasala'?

85. What was a 'Sadivihariya'?

86. Who were the 'Bhanakavaru' in the Buddhist tradition?

87. Which king's reign saw the first documentation of the 'Thripitaka'?

88. What is the meaning of the ritual 'Vas Visima'?

89. What does the term 'Katina Cheewaraya' refer to?

90. What does the term 'Sivikasala' represent in Hindu religious context?

91. Which ancient term in inscriptions refers to Tamil people?

92. Name two ancient Hindu temples located near major Sri Lankan harbours.

93. The stone cross found in Anuradhapura belongs to which Christian sect?

94. What was the name used by Arabs to refer to Sri Lanka in the 9th century?

95. According to 'Ajayib Al-Hind', why did a group from Sri Lanka travel to Arabia?

96. How was knowledge primarily passed down in Sri Lanka before formal institutions?

97. What became the main educational centers after Buddhism was established?

98. List three languages commonly used in the literature of the Rajarata Civilization.

99. Name an example of an ancient Sri Lankan book written in Pali.

100. Name an example of an ancient Sri Lankan book written in Sanskrit.

101. Name an example of a literary work written in Sinhala.

102. Where can nearly 600 poems from the Anuradhapura period be found today?

103. What was a common theme in ancient Sri Lankan poetry due to Buddhist influence?

104. From which region did the 'Ionians' come to Sri Lanka for trade?

105. From which region did the 'Jawakans' originate?

106. What was the role of the 'Demala Adhikari' in the king's court?

107. Who were the 'Agampadi Senawa'?

108. How did the ancient Sri Lankan government treat the Muslim worship of Sri Pada (Adam's Peak)?

109. What is 'Padhanaghara'?

110. What does the word 'Niyamasthana' mean in inscriptions?

111. What are 'Cufic' letters?

112. In ancient inscriptions, what does the symbol of a 'swan' represent?

113. In ancient inscriptions, what does a crescent mark at the top symbolize?

114. What do the marks of a dog and a crow symbolize in an inscription?

115. The term 'Vatapatha' (fan) in inscriptions indicates which royal symbol?

116. Which king built a special hospital for an infectious fever called 'Upasaggaroganasa'?

117. What is the meaning of the word 'Pura' in ancient sources?

118. What was the main purpose of building tanks in the dry zone?

119. Which ancient profession used the name 'Kavi'?

120. What does 'Anuthewasika' refer to in a monastery?

121. Which historical source is an Arabic geographical book mentioning Sri Lanka as 'Sarandib'?

122. What does the term 'Ashwa Acharya' mean?

123. In the inscription of King Udaya IV, what is the focus of the administrative information?

124. Which 5th-century traveler mentioned Persian traders living in Anuradhapura?

125. According to Lokopakaraya, a person without education is compared to what?

MCQ-2018

12. There are evidence to show that there were three harvests of cultivation in ancient Sri Lanka. The decision of cultivating the third harvest was taken on the
- (1) discretion of the leader of the village. (2) amount of crop received in the last harvest.
(3) interest of the farmers. (4) possibility of receiving water.
13. The name used by the Arabs to describe Sri Lanka was
- (1) Seylan. (2) Taprobrane. (3) Serendib. (4) Tambapanni.

MCQ-2024

12. What is meant by 'Vejjasala'?

- (1) Hospitals
- (3) Theatres

- (2) Hindu religious centres
- (4) Educational centres

MCQ-2025

8. From among the following, what is known as "Thimbirige"?

- (1) The place constructed for the delivery of babies
- (2) The place where the conflicts were settled in the village
- (3) The place used for religious activities
- (4) The place where educational activities were conducted

2022 Q/3

3. (i) Name the **three** Kannas (harvests/seasons) in which paddy was cultivated in ancient society. (03 marks)
- (ii) Name **four** crops cultivated in chenas in the past. (04 marks)
- (iii) Describe with **two** points the existence of various industries in ancient times. (05 marks)
- (iv) Explain with **three** points the manner in which a systematic internal trade existed in the past. (06 marks)